

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

K RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly sunny 87/69 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny, hot 93/75 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, JUNE 20, 2025 • \$4

U.S. at risk of having excess EV batteries

Slower sales, GOP plan could leave companies with unneeded factories

BY SHANNON OSAKA

Over the past three years, companies have invested tens of billions of dollars toward making electric vehicles in the United States, buoyed by tax incentives aimed at helping American businesses compete with China.

Now, those companies are facing a strange problem: too much manufacturing capacity, not enough demand.

As sales of electric vehicles slow and congressional Republicans take aim at EV tax credits and incentives, the United States is slated to have more battery and EV manufacturing than it needs, according to a report released Wednesday by the Rhodium Group, a research firm. That could leave factories — many of which are already operating or under construction — stranded if car sales continue to slump.

“The rug is being pulled out from under these manufacturers,” said Hannah Pitt, a director in Rhodium’s energy and climate practice.

The Inflation Reduction Act, signed into law by President Joe Biden in 2022, included several provisions to push automakers to produce electric vehicles and electric car parts in the United States. One tax credit gives companies cash for producing battery components domestically; the consumer EV tax credit, meanwhile, offers \$7,500 to customers for an EV that is assembled in the United States with domestic battery parts and minerals.

After the law passed, battery investment in the U.S. skyrocketed. Companies went from investing about \$1 billion per quarter in 2022 to \$11 billion per quarter in

SEE BATTERIES ON A4



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Workers evacuate a patient from Soroka Medical Center in Beersheba, Israel, after the hospital was hit by an Iranian missile.

After strike on hospital, Israel threatens escalation

BY ILAN BEN ZION, ABBIE CHEESEMAN, LIOR SOROKA AND CLAIRE PARKER

BEERSHEBA, ISRAEL — An Iranian missile hit one of Israel’s largest hospitals on Thursday, damaging the facility, causing minor injuries and prompting vows of retribution from Israeli officials as they continued a week-long bombing campaign against Iran.

The missile struck the surgery department of Soroka Medical Center in the southern city of Beersheba shortly after 7 a.m. The blast sparked a fire in the building and shattered windows across the hospital complex.

Hospital officials said about 80 people were lightly injured. Shlomi Codish, the hospital’s director, said many of their injuries came

80 injured by a missile Iran says was aimed at IDF technology unit

from broken glass and ceiling debris. The wing that was hit directly was evacuated earlier, so the department was empty at the time of the attack, Codish told reporters.

Joseph Kushnir, a psychiatrist at the hospital, was on his way to work when the sirens went off. He arrived at the scene shortly after the strike and said he saw a column of thick black smoke rising above the hospital. “It was total chaos, basically,” he said. “We were prepared for a mass-casualty event; fortunately it

didn’t happen.”

At the time of the attack, 700 patients were at the hospital, the medical facility’s administration said in a statement on X. About 300 patients remain there.

IRNA, Iran’s official news agency, said Iran was targeting the headquarters of the Israel Defense Force’s elite technological unit and an “intelligence camp” in the Gav-Yam Negev Advanced Technologies Park about a mile from the hospital. The IDF has been preparing to move thousands of soldiers who perform technological functions to a newly built hub near that site, Israeli media reported. A military school for software and cyberdefense was inaugurated in the adjacent tech park in 2022.

The IDF press desk did not respond to requests for com-

ment.

Two areas in central Israel — in Ramat Gan and Holon — were also hit in the same early-morning barrage of Iranian missiles, which damaged apartment buildings and injured dozens of people, at least two seriously, according to Israel’s emergency services. The Israeli military’s Home Front Command said Iran had used a type of cluster bomb — a missile designed to scatter smaller munitions over a larger area — and warned civilians to look out for unexploded ordnance.

SEE ISRAEL ON A8

War powers: Effort in Senate would block unilateral action by Trump. **A5**

U.S. bases: Several could become targets if the U.S. attacks Iran. **A9**

Trump eases up on Iran war talk

WILL DECIDE WITHIN 2 WEEKS ON STRIKES

President sees a chance diplomacy may bear fruit

BY NATALIE ALLISON AND ELLEN FRANCIS

President Donald Trump will wait as much as two weeks to decide whether to attack Iran’s nuclear program, the White House said Thursday, dialing back rhetoric about Iran having missed its window to reach a deal.

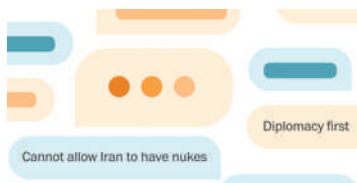
In a statement read by his press secretary, Trump said he believes there is now a “substantial chance of negotiations” with Iran.

White House officials are watching European talks with Iran scheduled for Friday as Trump suggested that he would wait to let discussions unfold.

In recent days, Trump’s comments on Iran have been belligerent, including a social media post Monday warning Iranians to “immediately evacuate Tehran,” the nation’s capital with 10 million residents, and a statement Wednesday that he was “out of patience.”

Thursday’s statement stood in sharp contrast: “Based on the fact that there’s a substantial chance of negotiations that may

SEE IRAN ON A7



Poll: Americans oppose U.S. strikes on Iran by a 20-point margin. **A10**

Japanese tourism dips after disaster prediction

Popular comic book claims ‘catastrophe’ will strike in July

BY MICHELLE YE HEE LEE AND CHIE TANAKA

SEOUL — A Japanese comic book’s premonition of an impending natural disaster in Japan has gotten some tourists so wigged out that they are avoiding the country this summer, prompting government officials to try to dispel rampant rumors about the prophecy.

The recent decline in sales of flights from some key Asian tourist markets to Japan has been attributed to a manga, or Japanese comic book, by Ryo Tatsuki: “The Future I Saw.”

In the original 1999 version, the book claimed that a “great disaster will occur in March 2011.” That month happened to be when a deadly triple disaster struck Japan’s Tohoku region: a devastating earthquake, tsunami and nuclear meltdown that triggered one of the biggest nuclear disas-

ters in history.

Then, in 2021, an updated version of the book claimed that “the real catastrophe” will come in July 2025, spinning fans and urban legend enthusiasts throughout East Asia into a tizzy.

Tatsuki’s theory has taken off online in recent months, with posts and videos on social media warning about a potential massive earthquake gaining millions of views from audiences including in Hong Kong, China, Taiwan and South Korea — all of which were in the top five tourist markets for Japan last year.

Now Japanese officials are scrambling to shut down these rumors and stop the panic.

“It is scientifically impossible to predict earthquakes by specifying the date, location or magnitude,” said Ryoichi Nomura, the head of Japan Meteorological Agency, at a news conference last month. “Therefore, any claims suggesting such specific predictions are completely false and should be regarded as misinformation.”

The Japanese government’s recent warnings of a potential “megaquake” that could trigger a

SEE MANGA ON A11



MARVIN JOSEPH/THE WASHINGTON POST

Juneteenth in the District

Denise Abrams dances with Delonte Allen outside the Go-Go Museum & Cafe in Anacostia on Thursday. During the Juneteenth Jubilee and Freedom Walk, marchers crossed the 11th Street Bridge — a route formerly known as “Freedom’s Crossing,” which was used by enslaved people to escape to Washington, where slavery was abolished in 1862. **Story, B1**

THE ECONOMY
Top U.S. executives are telling their employees to prepare for AI to transform or eliminate their jobs. **A12**

THE REGION
Aisha Braveboy, freshly sworn in as Prince George’s county executive, named a new police chief. **B1**

An anti-Trump statue has approval to be displayed on the National Mall until Sunday. **B1**

STYLE
Sen. Alex Padilla (D), muscled to the ground after interrupting a federal briefing, has been reflecting on whether it was worth it. **C1**

SPORTS
The Nationals’ 11-game losing streak is over thanks to James Wood’s walk-off home run in the 11th. **D1**

WEEKEND
The District’s best museum cafes not only reflect the venues’ impressive collections but also revel in good taste.

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OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A15
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A6

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IN THE NEWS

Starship explodes The SpaceX vehicle blew up ahead of an engine test, sending a large fireball skyward in Texas and dealing Elon Musk’s company another major setback. **A4**

Stabbing of Senate aide The man charged in an attack in D.C. in 2023 has again been found mentally incompetent to stand trial. **B1**

THE NATION
A man faces a charge of attempted kidnapping after an incident involving Memphis’s mayor. **A2**
Job protections for college professors are under siege in states across the country. **A3**

THE WORLD
The plane crash in India underscores the risk of dense construction close to airports. **A6**
Russia’s Vladimir Putin said he is open to meeting with Ukraine’s Volodymyr Zelensky. **A11**